

The Problem

Today, three islands exist in the home.

- m The PC Internet world where PC and PC peripherals communicate.
- m The broadcast world that serves set-top boxes and traditional consumer electronics.
- m The mobile world, consisting of multimedia mobile phones, PDAs, laptop computers and similar devices, that provides unparalleled connectivity and freedom of movement into and out of the home environment.

Consumers want devices in these three domains to work together in the home, but expectations have largely been unfulfilled. In order to build in interoperability between these digital worlds and win customer confidence, industry leaders must address the following challenges cited by consumers and substantiated by research.

Consumer challenges

- m Digital home products should be easy to install, provide obvious user value, and be affordable.
- m Digital home products must interoperate with each other and with existing consumer electronic devices like TVs and stereos. Manufacturers must also recognise that the vision of convergence has not been realised in the minds of the consumer.

Product Developers' Dilemma

- m Open industry standards are often too flexible - products built by different vendors many times do not interoperate well. Therefore, design choices should be narrowed through industry consensus to better achieve interoperability.
- m Current end-to-end solutions, based on proprietary vertical implementations, get products to market early - but have little impact on rapidly growing a new category. In summary, a digital home framework, defined by CE and PC industry leaders is required to enable an interoperable home network. Products built on this framework will enhance digital media distribution throughout the home.

The Vision

The digital home vision integrates the Internet, mobile, and broadcast islands through a seamless, interoperable network which will